

KERALA POLYTECHNIC — REVISION 2026

 Course 1144 Semester I Practicum 5 Credits

Shorthand English Theory I

A complete handbook for the phonographic system, alternative signs, circles, loops, hooks, shun hooks, and aspirates — with practice exercises, Malayalam support, and exam preparation.

Programme

Commercial Practice

Subject Code

1144

Subject Title

Shorthand English Theory I

Semester

I

Course Type

Practicum

Contact Hours

105

Teaching Scheme

3:0:4:0 (L:T:P:R)

Credits

5

CIE Marks

40

ESE Marks

60



Official Source Declaration

This handbook is based on the official Kerala Polytechnic Revision 2026 syllabus for Course 1144 — Shorthand English Theory I.

⚠ Verified Inconsistencies: The syllabus document contains minor formatting irregularities in the teaching scheme table (repeated "1" characters on pages 3 and 6) and some module-hour totals that appear as "120" for lecture hours rather than instructional-hour counts. These have been interpreted as 12 hours of theory instruction per module (120 minutes of lecture per week) based on the contact-hour breakdown. The practice exercises listed in each module are treated as practical (P) hours. All official content has been preserved as listed.

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Revision: 2026

Course Code: 1144



Course Dashboard

105

CONTACT HOURS

5

CREDITS

40+60

CIE + ESE MARKS

4

MODULES



Course Pre-requisite

Basic Knowledge in English grammar and composition — Secondary Education



Introduction

Shorthand English is an abbreviated, symbolic writing method that increases writing speed compared to standard "longhand". It enables writers to keep pace with spoken language

and is commonly used by journalists, secretaries, and court reporters for note-taking and documentation.

Teaching and Assessment Scheme

Teaching Scheme/Week	Self-learning (SS)/Week	Total Hours/Semester	Credits C	Theory			Practical		
				CIE	ESE	Total	CIE	ESE	Total
3:0:4:0	6.5	105	5	20	40	60	20	40	60

L: Lecture (one unit = one hour, one credit), T: Tutorial (one unit = one hour, one credit), P: Practical (one unit = one hour, 0.5 credit), R: Project (one unit = one hour, 0.5 credit), SS: Self-Learning, CIE: Continuous Internal Evaluation, ESE: End Semester Examination



How to Use This Handbook

A four-step approach to mastering Shorthand English Theory I.

1 Understand

Read each module's theory, definitions, and principles carefully. Use the Malayalam notes for clarity.

2 Visualise

Study the shorthand outlines and diagrams. Practice writing strokes and circles as shown.

3 Apply

Work through every practice exercise listed. Use the calculators and self-learning activities to reinforce learning.

4 Revise

Use the quick revision cards, module-wise questions, and model paper to test your readiness for exams.



Course Objectives & Outcomes



Objectives

1. To provide a thorough knowledge in Shorthand English Theory.
2. To get fundamental knowledge in the phonographic system.
3. To enable students to convert text to shorthand.
4. To read printed or written shorthand with ease and accuracy.

5. To attain speed in shorthand writing through practicing exercises.
6. To improve the English language of the students.

Course Outcomes (CO)

CO	Course Outcome	Bloom's Level
CO1	Apply basic knowledge of phonography system	Apply
CO2	Make use of alternatives signs for R & H, diphthongs, phraseography, and circles in shorthand	Apply
CO3	Identify loops and hooks	Apply
CO4	Apply shun hooks, aspirates	Apply

CO-PO Mapping

Course Articulation Matrix

CO	PO1	PO2	PO3	PO4	PO5	PO6	PO7	PO8	PO9	PO10	PO11	PO12
CO1	1	-	-	-	-	-	-	3	-	-	-	-
CO2	-	2	-	-	-	-	-	3	-	-	-	-
CO3	-	2	-	-	-	1	3	-	-	-	-	-
CO4	-	-	-	-	-	1	3	-	-	1	-	-

Legends: 1 — Low; 2 — Medium; 3 — High; No Correlation — "-"



Curriculum Coverage Map

Module	Title	Lecture Hrs	Practice Hrs	CO	Section
I	Basic knowledge of phonography system	12	16	CO1	Module 1
II	Alternatives signs for R & H, diphthongs, phraseography, circles	12	16	CO2	Module 2
III	Loops and hooks	12	16	CO3	Module 3
IV	Shun hooks, aspirates	9	12	CO4	Module 4



How the Modules Connect

A logical progression from basic phonography to advanced shorthand constructions.

1 Module I — Foundations

Phonographic system, consonants, vowels, grammalogues. The building blocks of shorthand.

2 Module II — Alternative Forms

R/H alternatives, diphthongs, phraseography, circle S/Z. Extending the shorthand system.

3 Module III — Loops & Hooks

Abbreviated forms, initial/final hooks, FR/VR alternatives, circle+hook combinations.

4 Module IV — Advanced

Shun hooks, aspirates, essay writing. Applying all principles in connected text.

MODULE I

Basic Knowledge of Phonography System

Understanding the foundational building blocks of Pitman Shorthand — consonants, vowels, vowel signs, and grammalogues.

12 Lecture Hours

16 Practice Hours

CO1

Bloom: Apply

►Phonographic System

The **phonographic system** is the foundation of Pitman Shorthand. Unlike alphabetical writing (longhand) which represents letters, phonography represents *sounds* of spoken language. It is a **phonetic** system — words are written as they sound, not as they are spelled.

Key Concept: "Write what you hear, not what you see." Shorthand is based on pronunciation, not spelling.

Principles of Phonography

Sound-based: Each symbol represents a sound (phoneme), not a letter.

Light and heavy strokes: Differentiate voiced and unvoiced sounds.

Position writing: Vowels are indicated by the position of the stroke relative to the line of writing.

Consonantal skeleton: The outline represents the consonants of a word; vowels are added as needed.

EXAMPLE

Word "cat": In phonography, we write the consonant sounds K and T. The vowel A is indicated by the position of the stroke — written above the line.

Malayalam support: Phonography എന്നത് ശബ്ദങ്ങളെ അടിസ്ഥാനമാക്കിയുള്ള എഴുത്തു രീതിയാണ്. "Cat" എന്ന വാക്ക് phonographic ആയി K + T എന്നീ ശബ്ദങ്ങൾ ആയി മാറ്റി, A എന്ന sound-position ആയി സൂചിപ്പിക്കുന്നു.

► Consonants — Meaning, Arrangement, Classes, and Groups

Consonants are speech sounds produced with partial or complete closure of the vocal tract. In Pitman Shorthand, consonants are represented by **strokes** — straight or curved lines drawn in specific directions.

Arrangement of Groups

Consonants are arranged in **pairs** of light and heavy strokes:

Light strokes represent unvoiced consonants (e.g., P, T, CH, K, F, TH, S, SH)

Heavy strokes represent voiced consonants (e.g., B, D, J, G, V, DH, Z, ZH)

Consonant Pairs — Light and Heavy Strokes

Unvoiced (Light)	Voiced (Heavy)	Stroke Type
P	B	Straight downward
T	D	Straight downward
CH	J	Curved
K	G	Straight downward
F	V	Curved
TH	DH	Curved
S	Z	Circle/Stroke
SH	ZH	Curved

Classes of Consonants

Consonants are grouped into **classes** based on where in the mouth they are formed:

Labials: P, B — formed with lips

Dentals: T, D — formed with tongue against teeth

Gutturals: K, G — formed in the throat

Palatals: CH, J — formed with tongue against hard palate

Labio-dentals: F, V — formed with lip and teeth

Dento-labials: TH, DH — formed with tongue between teeth

Sibilants: S, Z, SH, ZH — hissed sounds

Practice Exercises 1-4: Write the consonants in pairs, practice the stroke directions, and identify voiced/unvoiced pairs.

Remember: The direction of the stroke matters — each consonant has a specific direction. Practice with the instructor's key to ensure correct formation.

Malayalam support: Consonants (വ്യഞ്ജനങ്ങൾ) — light strokes (നേർത്ത വരകൾ) unvoiced sounds-നും, heavy strokes (കട്ടിയുള്ള വരകൾ) voiced sounds-നും ഉപയോഗിക്കുന്നു. P/B, T/D, K/G എന്നിവ മുഖ്യ ജോഡികളാണ്.

► Vowels — Sounds, Signs, Placing, and Intervening Vowels

Vowels are speech sounds produced without obstruction of the vocal tract. In Pitman Shorthand, vowels are represented by **dots** and **dashes** placed in specific positions relative to the consonant stroke.

Vowel Sounds

There are **six long vowels** and **six short vowels** in English phonetic shorthand:

Vowel Sounds with Examples

Sound	Example	Symbol
ē (long E)	beet, see	Dot (light)
ī (short I)	bit, sit	Dot (heavy)
ā (long A)	bait, say	Dash (light)
ě (short E)	bet, set	Dash (heavy)
ä (long A)	father, arm	Dot (light — 3rd position)
ō (short O)	not, hot	Dash (heavy — 3rd position)

Vowel Signs and Placing

Vowel signs are placed at **three positions** relative to the consonant stroke:

First position: Before the stroke (beginning of word) — e.g., "ate" = vowel before consonant

Second position: At the stroke (middle of word) — e.g., "bat" = vowel at the stroke

Third position: After the stroke (end of word) — e.g., "bait" = vowel after consonant

EXAMPLE

Word "be": B stroke (heavy, downward) + light dot (ē) at the stroke → the outline represents "be".

Word "bit": B stroke + heavy dot (ī) at the stroke + T stroke (light, downward).

Intervening Vowels

Intervening vowels are vowels that occur between two consonants. They are indicated by the **position of the following stroke** relative to the previous stroke, rather than by a separate vowel sign.

Key Principle: In connected shorthand, vowels are often implied by the position of strokes rather than written explicitly. This increases writing speed.

Practice Exercises 5-12: Practice vowel identification, placing vowel signs, and reading words with intervening vowels.

Malayalam support: Vowels (സ്വരങ്ങൾ) — dot (ബിന്ദു) ഉം dash (രേഖ) ഉം ആണ് പ്രധാന symbols. Position 1 (beginning), Position 2 (middle), Position 3 (end) എന്നിവ vowels-ന്റെ സ്ഥാനം നിർണ്ണയിക്കുന്നു.

► Grammalogues and Punctuations

Grammalogues are frequently occurring words that are represented by a single shorthand sign (a stroke, a circle, or a tick). They form the "common words" that speed up writing significantly.

Common Grammalogues

Important Grammalogues

Word	Shorthand Sign	Usage
and	Light slanting stroke	Conjunction
of	Light horizontal stroke	Preposition
for	Heavy slanting stroke	Preposition
to	Light tick	Preposition/Infinitive
with	Circle	Preposition
the	Heavy tick	Article
you	Light stroke	Pronoun
I	Light stroke	Pronoun

Punctuation in Shorthand

Period (.) : Light horizontal tick

Comma (,) : Light upward stroke

Question mark (?) : Dot with a tick

Exclamation (!) : Heavy dot with a downward stroke

Exam Tip: Grammalogues are the most frequently tested items in theory exams. Memorise at least 50 common grammalogues for high-speed writing.

Malayalam support: Grammalogues (സാധാരണ പദങ്ങളുടെ സങ്കേതങ്ങൾ) — "and", "of", "for", "to", "with", "the" തുടങ്ങിയ വാക്കുകൾ single strokes കൊണ്ട് എഴുതാം. ഇത് speed വർദ്ധിപ്പിക്കും.

► General Knowledge — Current Affairs and Who's Who

As shorthand is used in journalism, legal reporting, and administrative documentation, general knowledge — particularly **current affairs** and **who's who** — is essential for:

Understanding context in dictation passages

Spelling names and terms correctly in transcription

Recognising abbreviations and acronyms

Recommended Areas of GK for Shorthand Students

Government: President, Prime Minister, Chief Ministers, Governors

International: UN, WHO, World Bank, IMF heads

Business: Major companies, stock exchanges, economic indicators

Sports: Major tournaments, record holders

Science: Nobel Prize winners, major discoveries

Self-Learning Activity: Prepare 20 MCQs relating to current affairs. This helps in understanding dictation passages and improving general awareness.

Malayalam support: Current affairs (നടപ്പ് സംഭവങ്ങൾ) — shorthand dictation-ൽ വരുന്ന പേരുകളും സംഭവങ്ങളും മനസ്സിലാക്കാൻ സഹായിക്കുന്നു. ഇത് transcription accuracy വർദ്ധിപ്പിക്കും.

Module I Summary: Phonography is sound-based writing. Consonants are stroke pairs (light/unvoiced, heavy/voiced). Vowels are dots/dashes in three positions. Grammalogues are single-sign common words. Practice exercises 1-12 build the foundation.

MODULE II

Alternatives for R & H, Diphthongs, Phraseography, and Circles

Extending the shorthand system with alternative signs for R and H, diphthongs, phraseography, and the use of circles for S and Z.

 12 Lecture Hours

 16 Practice Hours

 CO2

 Bloom: Apply

► Alternatives of R and H

In Pitman Shorthand, **R** and **H** have alternative representations depending on their position in a word and the surrounding strokes.

Alternative Forms of R

Regular R: A curved stroke (initial, medial, or final)

R Hook: A small hook added to a stroke to represent R after the consonant

R Circle: A circle used to represent R in certain combinations

R Upward: Used in words like "are" as a grammalogue

Alternative Forms of H

Regular H: A light downward stroke

H Hook: A small hook added to a stroke to represent H before a vowel

Aspirate H: In certain dialects, H is represented by a specific stroke

EXAMPLE

Word "try": T stroke + R hook = single outline for "try".

Word "who": H stroke (aspirate) + circle for 'oo' sound.

Key Rule: Use the alternative form that is most efficient for the combination of letters. Practice helps identify which form to use.

Malayalam support: R-ന്റെ alternative forms (hook, circle, upward) — word-ന്റെ ഘടന അനുസരിച്ച് മാറുന്നു. H-ന് aspirate form ഉം hook ഉം ഉപയോഗിക്കുന്നു.

► Diphthongs and Triphones

Diphthongs are vowel sounds that consist of a **glide** from one vowel to another within the same syllable. In Pitman Shorthand, diphthongs are represented by **two vowel signs joined** by a light curve.

Common Diphthongs

Diphthongs and Their Representations

Diphthong	Example	Symbol
ī (as in "ice")	ice, my, high	Light dot + dash
ou (as in "out")	out, now, how	Heavy dash + dot
oi (as in "oil")	oil, boy, toy	Dot + tick
ow (as in "own")	own, go, show	Dash + tick

Triphones

Triphones are three-vowel glides (rare in English). They are represented by **combining diphthong symbols** with an additional vowel sign.

Remember: Diphthongs and triphones are written as **one unit** with a single connecting stroke. This saves space and increases speed.

Malayalam support: Diphthongs (സ്വരസന്ധികൾ) — "ice", "out", "oil" തുടങ്ങിയ വാക്കുകളിലെ vowel glides. Triphones — three vowels in one syllable.

►Phraseography — Principles and Qualities of Good Phraseograms

Phraseography is the art of writing two or more words as **one outline** (a phraseogram). This dramatically increases shorthand speed.

Principles of Phraseography

Common phrases: Write frequent word combinations as one unit — "I am", "you will", "in the", etc.

Grammalogues in phrases: Combine grammalogues with other strokes — "and the", "of the", "for the"

Position writing: The position of the phraseogram indicates the overall meaning

Intersecting strokes: Use strokes that intersect or touch to form phraseograms

Qualities of a Good Phraseogram

Legibility: Must be immediately readable

Speed: Should be faster than writing words separately

Consistency: Should follow predictable rules

Distinctiveness: Should not be confused with other phraseograms

EXAMPLES OF COMMON PHRASEOGRAMS

"I am": Light stroke for "I" + heavy stroke for "am" (combined)

"in the": Circle for "in" + heavy tick for "the"

"you will": Stroke for "you" + upward stroke for "will"

Practice: Practice grammalogues and exercises 13, 15, 17, 19, 21, 22, 23, 25, 28, 30, 31, and 34 for phraseography.

Malayalam support: Phraseography — വാക്കുകളുടെ സംയുക്ത രൂപം. "I am" എന്നത് ഒരു outline ആയി എഴുതാം. ഇത് speed വർദ്ധിപ്പിക്കും.

►Circles — S and Z, Large Circles, Stroke S and Z

In Pitman Shorthand, the **circle** represents the sound of **S** or **Z**. The circle is one of the most versatile and frequently used signs.

Circle S and Z

Small circle: Represents the sound of S or Z

Large circle: Represents the sound of S and Z together (as in "size", "seize")

Placement: The circle can be placed at the beginning, middle, or end of a stroke

Comparing Circle S and Stroke S

Circle S: Used when S is a separate sound, often at the end of a word (e.g., "books" — B+K+S with circle)

Stroke S: Used when S is the main consonant (e.g., "see", "so") or in certain combinations

Circle S/Z Usage

Type	Position	Example
Small circle	End of stroke	"books" (B + K + S)
Small circle	Beginning of stroke	"sack" (S + K)
Large circle	Between strokes	"size" (S + Z)

Memory Aid: If the S sound is just an "extra" sound, use a circle. If S is the main consonant, use the stroke.

Malayalam support: Circle S/Z — "books" (B+K+S) എന്നതിൽ S circle ആയി എഴുതാം. "see" എന്നതിൽ S stroke ആയി എഴുതുന്നു.

► Writing Formal and Informal Letters

Shorthand is extensively used for drafting and transcribing correspondence. Understanding the structure of formal and informal letters is essential.

Formal Letter Structure

Sender's address: Top right/left

Date: Below sender's address

Recipient's address: Left side

Subject line: "Sub:" or "Re:"

Salutation: "Dear Sir/Madam," "Respected..."

Body: Formal language, structured paragraphs

Complimentary close: "Yours faithfully," "Yours sincerely,"

Signature: Name and designation

Informal Letter Structure

Sender's address: Less formal, often omitted

Date: Casual format

Salutation: "Dear [Name]," "Hi [Name],"

Body: Conversational, shorter paragraphs

Complimentary close: "Yours lovingly," "With love," "Regards,"

Signature: First name only

Self-Learning Activity: Write one sample formal and one informal letter in shorthand. Practice transcribing them back to longhand.

Malayalam support: Formal letter — official correspondence-ന് ഉപയോഗിക്കുന്നു. Informal letter — personal correspondence-ന് ഉപയോഗിക്കുന്നു. Shorthand-ൽ letter writing speed വർദ്ധിപ്പിക്കും.

 **Module II Summary:** Alternative forms for R/H reduce outline length. Diphthongs combine two vowel sounds. Phraseography writes multiple words as one. Circles represent S/Z efficiently. Practice exercises 13-34 reinforce these principles.

MODULE III

Loops and Hooks

Understanding loops as abbreviated forms, initial and final hooks, alternative forms FR/VR, and combinations with circles.

 12 Lecture Hours

 16 Practice Hours

 CO3

 Bloom: Apply

► Loops — Initial, Medial, and Final Positions

Loops are curved extensions added to strokes to represent certain consonant combinations. They function as **abbreviated forms** to save space and increase speed.

Position of Loops

Initial loop: Added at the beginning of a stroke — represents "ST" or "STR"

Medial loop: Added in the middle of a stroke — represents "R" or "L"

Final loop: Added at the end of a stroke — represents "TR" or "DR"

Loops and Their Meanings

Loop Type	Position	Represents	Example
Small final loop	End of stroke	TR	"better" (B + T with loop)
Large final loop	End of stroke	DR	"fader" (F + D with loop)
Initial loop	Beginning of stroke	ST	"stay" (ST + A)

EXAMPLE

Word "better": B (heavy downward stroke) + small final loop = outline for "better" (B + T + R).

Word "stay": Initial loop + T (light downward stroke) + vowel placement = outline for "stay".

Self-Learning: Prepare a list of 15 words using loops other than the textbook to practice identifying loop positions.

Malayalam support: Loops (വളവുകൾ) — shorthand-ൽ ഉപയോഗിക്കുന്ന abbreviated forms. Initial, medial, final എന്നീ positions-ൽ loops ചേർക്കാം. "better" എന്നതിൽ final loop ഉപയോഗിക്കുന്നു.

► Initial Hooks and Final Hooks

Hooks are small curved additions to strokes that represent additional consonants. They are classified as **initial hooks** (added at the beginning) and **final hooks** (added at the end).

Initial Hooks

Added at the **beginning** of a stroke

Represent consonants like **R, L, or W**

Common in words beginning with "pr", "pl", "br", "bl", "kr", "kl", etc.

Final Hooks

Added at the **end** of a stroke

Represent consonants like **R, L, N, or F/V**

Common in words ending with "er", "or", "el", "le", "en", "on", etc.

EXAMPLES

"pray": P (heavy stroke) + initial R hook

"play": P (heavy stroke) + initial L hook

"maker": M (heavy stroke) + K (light stroke) + final R hook

"fable": F (light curved stroke) + B (heavy stroke) + final L hook

Self-Learning: Prepare a list of 20 words using hooks other than the textbook to practice hook identification and formation.

Malayalam support: Initial hooks (ആദ്യത്തെ കൊളുത്തുകൾ) — "pray", "play" എന്നിവയിൽ R/L hook. Final hooks (അവസാനത്തെ കൊളുത്തുകൾ) — "maker", "fable" എന്നിവയിൽ R/L hook.

► Alternative Forms FR and VR

In Pitman Shorthand, **FR** and **VR** have special alternative forms that are more efficient than writing F+V/R separately.

FR Alternative

Represented by an **F stroke with an initial R hook** — or a **curved stroke** combining both sounds
Used in words like "free", "front", "friend"

VR Alternative

Represented by a **V stroke with an initial R hook** — or a **curved stroke** combining both sounds
Used in words like "very", "various", "virtue"

EXAMPLES

"free": F (light curved stroke) + initial R hook = single outline for "free"

"very": V (heavy curved stroke) + initial R hook + vowel placement

Key Rule: The FR/VR alternatives are used when the R sound follows immediately after F or V. This is more efficient than writing two separate strokes.

Malayalam support: FR/VR alternatives — "free", "very" എന്നിവയിൽ F/V stroke-നൊപ്പം R hook ചേർത്ത് single outline ആക്കാം.

► Circle or Loop Preceding Initial Hooks

When a **circle (S/Z)** or a **loop (ST/STR)** precedes a stroke that already has an initial hook, the outline becomes more complex. Understanding the **order of addition** is crucial.

Rules for Circle/Loop + Hook Combinations

Circle first: If the word starts with S/Z, write the circle *before* the hook

Loop first: If the word starts with ST/STR, write the loop *before* the hook

The hook is added to the stroke *after* the circle/loop

EXAMPLES

"spring": S circle + P (heavy stroke) + R hook + stroke for "ing"

"strong": ST loop + R hook + stroke for "ong"

"screen": S circle + K (heavy stroke) + R hook + stroke for "een"

Practice: Identifying circles with hooks in different motions requires dedicated practice. Exercise 35, 37, revisionary exercise A, and exercises 39-58 cover these combinations.

Malayalam support: Circle/loop + initial hook — "spring", "strong" എന്നിവയിൽ S/ST ആദ്യം, എന്നിട്ട് hook. Order of writing മനസ്സിലാക്കേണ്ടത് പ്രധാനമാണ്.

► N and F/V Hooks to Straight and Curved Strokes

Hooks for **N** and **F/V** can be added to both straight and curved strokes, with different positions depending on the stroke shape.

N Hook

Represents the sound of **N** or **EN/ON**

Added at the **end** of a stroke

To straight strokes: Hook is on the *same side* as the circle

To curved strokes: Hook follows the curve direction

F/V Hook

Represents the sound of **F** or **V** (or "ove", "ive")

Added at the **end** of a stroke

To straight strokes: Hook is on the *opposite side* from the circle

To curved strokes: Hook follows the natural curve direction

Hook Types for Straight and Curved Strokes

Hook	Straight Stroke Position	Curved Stroke Position	Example
N hook	Same side as circle	Inner curve	"pen" (P + N hook)
F/V hook	Opposite side from circle	Outer curve	"have" (H + V hook)

Key Distinction: The side of the hook is critical — N hook and F/V hook are on *opposite* sides of straight strokes. This distinction prevents confusion in reading.

Malayalam support: N hook (N ശബ്ദം) — circle ഉള്ള വശത്ത്. F/V hook (F/V ശബ്ദം) — circle ഇല്ലാത്ത വശത്ത്. ഈ distinction reading accuracy-ന് പ്രധാനമാണ്.

►Circles and Loops to Final Hooks

When a stroke has a **final hook**, a **circle (S/Z)** or **loop (ST/STR)** can be added to create more complex outlines.

Rules for Final Hook + Circle/Loop

Circle after final hook: The circle is written *after* the final hook — represents "S" or "Z" at the end

Loop after final hook: The loop is written *after* the final hook — represents "STR" at the end

The order is: **Stroke → Final Hook → Circle/Loop**

EXAMPLES

"letters": L + T (with final hook for R) + circle for S

"monsters": M + N (with final hook for T/ST) + loop for STR + circle for S

Practice: Exercises 50, 52, 54, 56, and 58 cover circles and loops with final hooks. Practice identifying the order of addition.

Malayalam support: Final hook + circle/loop — "letters" എംതൽ L + T (R hook) + S circle. Order of writing: stroke → final hook → circle/loop.

📌 **Module III Summary:** Loops (initial/medial/final) abbreviate ST/STR/TR/DR. Hooks (initial/final) add R/L/N/F/V. FR/VR have special forms. Circle/loop + hook combinations require careful order. Practice exercises 35-58 build proficiency.

MODULE IV

Shun Hooks and Aspirates

Applying advanced principles of shun hooks, aspirates, and essay writing to produce fluent shorthand.

📖 9 Lecture Hours

✎ 12 Practice Hours

🎯 CO4

📊 Bloom: Apply

► Principles Covering Shun Hooks

"**Shun**" **hooks** are hooks that represent the sound **-tion, -sion, -ssion, -cian, -tian** — words ending with the "shun" sound (e.g., "nation", "mission", "physician").

Key Principles

The "shun" sound is represented by a **final hook** added to the last consonant stroke

The hook is placed on the **opposite side** from the circle (if present)

Words ending with "-tion" are written as: **consonant stroke + shun hook**

Words ending with "-sion" may require an additional circle before the hook

Shun Hook Examples

Word	Shorthand Outline	Hook Type
nation	N + shun hook	Final hook (opposite side)
mission	M + circle (S) + shun hook	Final hook with circle
physician	F + SH stroke + shun hook	Final hook

EXAMPLE: "NATION"

N (heavy downward stroke) + shun hook on the *opposite side* from the circle = outline for "nation". This distinguishes it from "notion" (N + shun hook on the same side).

Key Rule: The side of the shun hook is critical for distinguishing different "-tion" words. Practice writing and reading shun hooks carefully.

Malayalam support: Shun hooks — "-tion", "-sion" endings. "nation" (N + shun hook), "mission" (M + S circle + shun hook). Hook-ന്റെ side reading-ന് പ്രധാനമാണ്.

►Aspirates in Shorthand — Different Forms

Aspirates are sounds produced with a **breath of air** (like the 'h' in "hat"). In shorthand, aspirates have specific representations.

Forms of Aspirates

- Regular H:** A light downward stroke — used for words beginning with 'h' like "hat", "him"
- H Hook:** A hook added to a stroke to represent H before a vowel — used in words like "who", "whom"
- Aspirate with vowel:** The aspirate sound combined with a vowel sign
- Silent H:** When H is silent (e.g., "hour", "honest"), no aspirate sign is written

Aspirate Forms

Form	Representation	Example
Regular H	Light downward stroke	"hat" (H + A + T)
H Hook	Hook on a stroke	"who" (W + H hook)
Aspirate + vowel	H stroke with vowel sign	"her" (H + vowel placement)

Remember: Not all 'h' sounds are aspirated in English. Words like "hour", "honest", "heir" have a silent h — no aspirate sign is used.

Malayalam support: Aspirates (ശ്വാസമുള്ള ശബ്ദങ്ങൾ) — 'h' എന്ന sound. Regular H, H hook എന്നിവ aspirates-ന്റെ രൂപങ്ങൾ. Silent H (hour, honest) — aspirate sign എഴുതേണ്ട.

► Principles of Essay Writing in Shorthand

Essay writing in shorthand requires **planning, structure, and execution** — applying all the shorthand principles learned in Modules I–IV.

Essay Writing Requirements

Topic understanding: Read and understand the essay prompt fully

Planning: Outline the key points before writing

Structure: Introduction → Body (3–4 paragraphs) → Conclusion

Speed: Maintain consistent speed while ensuring legibility

Accuracy: Correct grammar, spelling, punctuation in transcription

Principles of Good Essay Writing in Shorthand

Write in phrases: Use phraseography to increase speed

Use grammalogues: Apply all grammalogues correctly

Maintain position: Vowel placement should be consistent

Review and proofread: Check transcription against the original dictation

Practice: Practice passages including grammalogues. Transcribe passages to longhand from newspapers to build speed and accuracy.

Malayalam support: Essay writing — shorthand-ൽ structure, speed, accuracy എന്നിവ പ്രധാനമാണ്. Phraseography, grammalogues എന്നിവ ഉപയോഗിച്ച് speed വർദ്ധിപ്പിക്കുക.

■ **Module IV Summary:** Shun hooks represent "-tion/-sion" endings. Aspirates represent 'h' sounds. Essay writing applies all shorthand principles. Practice exercises 59, 61, 63, 65, and 67 reinforce these advanced concepts.



Formula Bank

Key shorthand principles and rules organised for quick reference.

Consonant Pairs

Light = Unvoiced (P,T,CH,K,F,TH,S,SH)

Heavy = Voiced (B,D,J,G,V,DH,Z,ZH)

Vowel Positions

Position 1: Before stroke (beginning)

Position 2: At stroke (middle)

Position 3: After stroke (end)

Circle S/Z

Small circle = S or Z

Large circle = S + Z together

Loops

Initial = ST/STR

Medial = R/L

Final = TR/DR

Hooks

Initial hooks = R/L/W

Final hooks = R/L/N/F/V

Shun hooks = -tion/-sion

Phraseography

Common phrases as one outline

Grammalogues + strokes

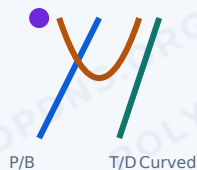
Intersecting/touching strokes



Visual Library — Diagram Reference

Key diagrams from each module for rapid revision.

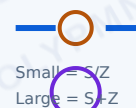
Consonant Stroke Directions



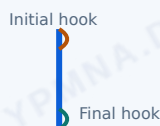
Vowel Signs



Circle S/Z



Hook Positions



Jump to: [Module I](#) · [Module II](#) · [Module III](#) · [Module IV](#)



Self-Learning Activities

Official activities for self-learning, organised by module.

Module I — Activities (Weeks 1-4)

- **Week 1:** Write a set of words and read the consonants according to the phonography (6.5 hrs)
- **Week 2:** Identify the vowels and read the words from the given sets of words (6.5 hrs)
- **Week 3:** Identify vowel places and write the words from the given sets of words (6.5 hrs)
- **Week 4:** Prepare 20 MCQs relating to current affairs; Practice exercises up to vowels (6.5 hrs)

Module II — Activities (Weeks 5-8)

- **Week 5:** Activities for identifying and writing circles in words (6.5 hrs)
- **Week 6:** Identify diphthongs and triphones from sets of words (6.5 hrs)
- **Week 7:** Write one sample formal and informal letter (6.5 hrs)
- **Week 8:** Prepare a comparative chart showing formal Vs informal letter outlines in shorthand (6.5 hrs)

Module III — Activities (Weeks 9-12)

- **Week 9:** Prepare a list of 15 words using loops other than text book (6.5 hrs)

- **Week 10:** Prepare a list of 20 words using hooks other than text book (6.5 hrs)
- **Week 11:** Activities for identifying circles with hooks in different motions (6.5 hrs)
- **Week 12:** Write and compare different hooks; Practice exercises in hooks (6.5 hrs)

Module IV — Activities (Weeks 13-15)

- **Week 13:** Activities for identifying kinds of aspirates (6.5 hrs)
- **Week 14:** Write essays on different relevant topics (6.5 hrs)
- **Week 15:** Practice passages including grammalogues; Transcribe passages to longhand from newspapers (6.5 hrs)



Assessment Methodology

Practicum Assessment Scheme

Mode	Duration	Exam Mark	Converted to	Tentative Schedule
Attendance	—	—	5	End of semester
CA1 — Average of Self-learning activities from each module	—	15	5	By 4th week
CA2 — Continuous evaluation	—	40	10	By 7th week
CA3 — Practical test (first half of experiments)	2 hours	40	10	By 11th week
CA4 — Practical test (second half of experiments)	2 hours	50	10	By 14th week
CA5 — Series Exam (2 modules)	2.5 hours	50	10	8th week
Series Exam (2 modules)	2.5 hours	60	10	15th week
ESE — Written Exam (theory)	—	40	—	End of semester
ESE — Lab Examination (internal)	3 hours	60	—	End of semester
Total CIE: 40 marks (converted from 100+ internal marks) · Total ESE: 60 marks				



Continuous Internal Evaluation (CIE) — Practical

Scheme of Evaluation — Practical (Continuous Internal Evaluation)

Criteria	Description	Marks
Preparation & Practice	Regular practice, completion of exercises, record maintenance	10
Observation & Data Recording	Correct outlines, proper use of rules	5
Analysis & Result Interpretation	Accuracy in converting shorthand to longhand	10
Viva Voce / Concept Understanding	Grammalogues, phraseography, loops, hooks	10
Workmanship, Discipline & Teamwork	Understanding of theory and rules	5
Discipline & Consistency	Attendance, punctuality, engagement	10
Total		50

 Practical Test Evaluation

Scheme of Evaluation — Practical Test

Category	Things to Evaluate	Marks
Write-up / Procedure	Aim of the exercise, knowledge of shorthand rules, readiness for the test	10
Shorthand Writing (Dictation Execution)	Speed in writing (WPM), ability to follow dictation accurately, proper formation of outlines, neatness and legibility	5
Transcription / Output	Accuracy in converting shorthand to longhand, correct spelling, punctuation, completeness of passage	8
Application of Techniques	Use of grammalogues, phraseography, loops, hooks, shun forms, aspirates appropriately	8
Viva Voce	Understanding of shorthand principles, ability to explain outlines, theoretical knowledge	4
Record	Completion and neatness of shorthand notebook, regular practice exercises, proper certification	5
Total		40

 Series Examination Pattern — Theory

Time	Module	Part A (Marks)	Part B (Marks)	Part C With Choice (Marks)	Total		
2 hours	Any two modules	21	33	27	25		
	Any two modules	21	33	22	25		
	Number of Questions			4	6	4	50

? Module-wise Questions with Answers

Practice questions for each module to test your understanding.

Module I — Phonography System

Q:What is the phonographic system? Explain its principles.

The phonographic system is the foundation of Pitman Shorthand. It is a **phonetic** system — words are written as they sound, not as they are spelled.

Principles:

- **Sound-based:** Each symbol represents a sound (phoneme), not a letter.
- **Light and heavy strokes:** Differentiate voiced and unvoiced sounds.
- **Position writing:** Vowels are indicated by the position of the stroke relative to the line of writing.
- **Consonantal skeleton:** The outline represents the consonants of a word; vowels are added as needed.

Example: "cat" = K + T with vowel placement for A.

Q:Describe the arrangement of consonants in Pitman Shorthand. Explain the classes and groups.

Consonants are arranged in **pairs** of light and heavy strokes:

- **Light strokes** represent unvoiced consonants (P, T, CH, K, F, TH, S, SH)
- **Heavy strokes** represent voiced consonants (B, D, J, G, V, DH, Z, ZH)

Classes based on articulation: Labials (P/B), Dentals (T/D), Gutturals (K/G), Palatals (CH/J), Labio-dentals (F/V), Dento-labials (TH/DH), Sibilants (S/Z/SH/ZH).

Q:What are vowel signs? Explain the three positions of placing vowel signs with examples.

Vowels are represented by **dots** and **dashes** placed in specific positions relative to the consonant stroke.

Three positions:

- **First position:** Before the stroke (beginning of word) — e.g., "ate"
- **Second position:** At the stroke (middle of word) — e.g., "bat"
- **Third position:** After the stroke (end of word) — e.g., "bait"

Example: "be" = B stroke + light dot (ē) at the stroke.

Q:What are grammalogues? Give examples of common grammalogues and their shorthand signs.

Grammalogues are frequently occurring words represented by a single shorthand sign.

Examples:

- and — Light slanting stroke
- of — Light horizontal stroke
- for — Heavy slanting stroke
- to — Light tick
- with — Circle
- the — Heavy tick
- you — Light stroke
- I — Light stroke

Module II — Alternatives, Diphthongs, Phraseography, Circles

Q:Explain the alternative forms of R and H in Pitman Shorthand.

Alternative forms of R:

- Regular R — Curved stroke
- R Hook — Small hook added to a stroke for R after a consonant
- R Circle — Circle used in certain combinations
- R Upward — Used in words like "are"

Alternative forms of H:

- Regular H — Light downward stroke
- H Hook — Hook added to a stroke for H before a vowel
- Aspirate H — Specific stroke for aspirated H

Example: "try" = T + R hook; "who" = H stroke + circle.

Q:What are diphthongs and triphones? Give examples of each with their shorthand representations.

Diphthongs are vowel glides from one vowel to another within the same syllable. Represented by two vowel signs joined by a light curve.

- ī (as in "ice") — Light dot + dash
- ou (as in "out") — Heavy dash + dot
- oi (as in "oil") — Dot + tick
- ow (as in "own") — Dash + tick

Triphones are three-vowel glides, represented by combining diphthong symbols with an additional vowel sign.

Q:Explain phraseography. What are the principles and qualities of good phraseograms?

Phraseography is writing two or more words as one outline (a phraseogram).

Principles:

- Common phrases as one unit — "I am", "you will", "in the"
- Combine grammalogues — "and the", "of the"
- Position writing indicates overall meaning
- Intersecting or touching strokes form phraseograms

Qualities of good phraseograms: Legibility, speed, consistency, distinctiveness.

Example: "I am" = light stroke for "I" + heavy stroke for "am" (combined).

Q:Compare circle S and Z with stroke S and Z. When is each used?

Circle S/Z: Used when S/Z is an "extra" sound, often at the end of a word.

- Example: "books" = B + K + circle S
- Small circle = S or Z; Large circle = S + Z together

Stroke S/Z: Used when S/Z is the main consonant.

- Example: "see" = S stroke + vowel placement
- Used in words beginning with S or in certain combinations

Module III — Loops and Hooks

Q:What are loops in Pitman Shorthand? Explain their initial, medial, and final positions.

Loops are curved extensions added to strokes to represent certain consonant combinations.

- **Initial loop:** Beginning of stroke — represents ST or STR — Example: "stay"
- **Medial loop:** Middle of stroke — represents R or L
- **Final loop:** End of stroke — represents TR or DR — Example: "better" (B + T + loop)

Q: Explain initial hooks and final hooks with examples. What are the alternative forms FR and VR?

Initial hooks — added at the beginning of a stroke, represent R, L, or W.

- Example: "pray" = P + initial R hook; "play" = P + initial L hook

Final hooks — added at the end of a stroke, represent R, L, N, or F/V.

- Example: "maker" = M + K + final R hook; "fable" = F + B + final L hook

FR alternative: F stroke with initial R hook — "free"

VR alternative: V stroke with initial R hook — "very"

Q: How are circles or loops written preceding initial hooks? Give examples.

When a circle (S/Z) or loop (ST/STR) precedes an initial hook:

- **Order:** Circle/Loop → Hook → Stroke
- Write the circle/loop first, then add the hook to the stroke

Examples:

- "spring" = S circle + P + R hook
- "strong" = ST loop + R hook
- "screen" = S circle + K + R hook

Q: Explain N and F/V hooks to straight and curved strokes. How do they differ?

N hook — represents N or EN/ON:

- To straight strokes: same side as circle
- To curved strokes: inner curve
- Example: "pen" = P + N hook

F/V hook — represents F or V:

- To straight strokes: opposite side from circle
- To curved strokes: outer curve
- Example: "have" = H + V hook

Key distinction: N hook and F/V hook are on *opposite* sides of straight strokes.

Module IV — Shun Hooks and Aspirates

Q: Explain the principles covering shun hooks. Give examples of words with shun hooks.

Shun hooks represent the sound -tion, -sion, -ssion, -cian, -tian.

Principles:

- The "shun" sound is a final hook on the last consonant stroke
- The hook is placed on the *opposite side* from the circle (if present)
- Words ending with "-tion": consonant stroke + shun hook

Examples:

- "nation" = N + shun hook (opposite side)
- "mission" = M + circle (S) + shun hook
- "physician" = F + SH stroke + shun hook

Q:What are aspirates in shorthand? Explain their different forms with examples.

Aspirates are sounds produced with a breath of air (like 'h').

Forms:

- **Regular H:** Light downward stroke — "hat", "him"
- **H Hook:** Hook added to a stroke — "who", "whom"
- **Aspirate with vowel:** H stroke with vowel sign — "her"

Note: Silent H (hour, honest, heir) — no aspirate sign.

Q:Describe the principles of essay writing in shorthand. What are the key requirements?

Principles of essay writing in shorthand:

- **Write in phrases:** Use phraseography to increase speed
- **Use grammalogues:** Apply all grammalogues correctly
- **Maintain position:** Consistent vowel placement
- **Review and proofread:** Check transcription

Key requirements:

- Topic understanding
- Planning and outlining key points
- Structure: Introduction → Body (3–4 paragraphs) → Conclusion
- Maintain consistent speed while ensuring legibility
- Accuracy in transcription



Practice Model Paper

Based on the official pattern (not an official SITTR model question paper).

Shorthand English Theory I — Model Examination

Time: 2.5 hours | **Total Marks:** 50

Part A — Short Answers (4 × 3 = 12 marks)

1. What is the phonographic system? List its key principles. (3)
2. Explain the three positions of vowel signs with examples. (3)
3. What are grammalogues? Give four examples. (3)
4. Write short notes on diphthongs. (3)

Part B — Medium Answers (3 × 6 = 18 marks)

1. Explain phraseography with its principles and qualities of good phraseograms. (6)
2. Describe the use of circles (S and Z) in shorthand. Compare circle S with stroke S. (6)

3. Explain loops — initial, medial, and final positions — with examples. (6)

Part C — Long Answers (2 × 10 = 20 marks) (Choose any 2)

1. Explain the principles of shun hooks with at least five examples. (10)
2. Describe initial and final hooks in detail. Include alternative forms FR and VR. (10)
3. Write an essay in shorthand on any one of the following topics: (10)
 - (a) Advantages of shorthand in modern offices
 - (b) Career opportunities for shorthand professionals

Note: This is a practice model paper for revision purposes. The actual examination pattern may vary. Practice all modules thoroughly.

⚡ Quick Revision

Key points from each module for last-minute revision.

■ Module I — Foundations

- **Phonography:** Sound-based writing — "write what you hear"
- **Consonants:** Light (unvoiced) ↔ Heavy (voiced) pairs
- **Vowels:** Dots and dashes in 3 positions (before/at/after stroke)
- **Grammalogues:** Single-sign common words — and, of, for, to, with, the, you, I
- **Practice:** Exercises 1-12

■ Module II — Alternatives, Diphthongs, Phraseography

- **R alternatives:** Regular R, R hook, R circle, R upward
- **H alternatives:** Regular H, H hook, aspirate H
- **Diphthongs:** ī (ice), ou (out), oi (oil), ow (own)
- **Phraseography:** Two+ words as one outline
- **Circle S/Z:** Small (S/Z), Large (S+Z)
- **Practice:** Exercises 13-34

■ Module III — Loops & Hooks

- **Loops:** Initial (ST/STR), Medial (R/L), Final (TR/DR)
- **Hooks:** Initial (R/L/W), Final (R/L/N/F/V)
- **FR/VR:** F/V + R hook alternatives
- **Circle/Loop + Hook:** Circle/Loop first, then hook
- **N hook vs F/V hook:** Opposite sides of straight strokes
- **Practice:** Exercises 35-58

Module IV — Shun Hooks & Aspirates

- **Shun hooks:** -tion, -sion, -ssion — final hook (opposite side)
- **Aspirates:** Regular H, H hook, aspirate + vowel
- **Silent H:** hour, honest — no aspirate sign
- **Essay writing:** Structure, speed, accuracy
- **Practice:** Exercises 59–67

⚠ Common Mistakes to Avoid

- ❌ **Confusing light and heavy strokes** — Light = unvoiced, Heavy = voiced
- ❌ **Incorrect vowel placement** — Position 1/2/3 changes the word meaning
- ❌ **Wrong side for hooks** — N hook and F/V hook are on opposite sides
- ❌ **Missing silent H** — No aspirate sign for silent H words
- ❌ **Circle order with hooks** — Circle/Loop first, then hook
- ❌ **Inconsistent phraseograms** — Must be legible and consistent

✅ Exam Checklist

- ☐ Know all 50+ common grammalogues
- ☐ Understand vowel positions with examples
- ☐ Practice circle S/Z in different positions
- ☐ Master initial and final hooks
- ☐ Practice shun hooks with at least 10 examples
- ☐ Review phraseography — 10 common phraseograms
- ☐ Practice transcription speed (target: 60–80 WPM)

Glossary

Important Shorthand Terminology

Term	Meaning
Phonography	Sound-based writing system; writing words as they sound
Consonant	Speech sound with partial/complete vocal tract closure
Vowel	Speech sound with open vocal tract
Grammologue	Common word represented by a single shorthand sign
Diphthong	Glide from one vowel to another within a syllable
Triphone	Three-vowel glide within a syllable
Phraseography	Writing two or more words as one outline
Phraseogram	A single outline representing multiple words
Loop	Curved extension added to a stroke (ST/STR/TR/DR)
Hook	Small curved addition to a stroke (R/L/N/F/V)
Shun hook	Hook representing -tion, -sion, -ssion
Aspirate	Sound produced with a breath of air ('h')
Stroke	A single shorthand sign representing a consonant
Outline	The complete shorthand representation of a word
Transcription	Converting shorthand back to longhand
WPM	Words Per Minute — shorthand writing speed



Learning Resources



Textbooks

- **Pitman Shorthand Instructor and Key** — Issac Pitman, Wheeler



References

- **Enrich Your Theory** — Bhagavan Associates



Web Resources

- <https://nssbooks.com/learn-shorthand> — All Modules
- <https://www.englishgrammar.org> — Modules II & IV



Search Handbook

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